

THE SCEPTER OF TYR

A Dungeons & Dragons 5e adventure

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The Scepter of Tyr

dark fantasy, moral choices

D&D 5e (2014)

Level 8-10

Duration: campaign (4 modules, 8-12 sessions)

Structure: linear

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△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

The Scepter of Tyr

Lore

Lo Scettro di Tyr is a divine weapon said to have been wielded by Tyr himself. Only the pure can use it without suffering the curse that consumes the soul and transforms the bearer into an undead servant. The Scepter was lost during the **Fall of the Temple of Lumina**, when a priest corrupted by Vecna attempted to steal it. **Ormut**, a spellcaster devoted to Tyr, teleported it to an unknown location — the **Kingdom of Erythale**, an ethereal plane of light and crystal — before dying at the hands of the traitors.

Since then, the Scepter has become the stuff of legends. **Vecna**, the God of Secrets, wants it to amplify his dark power and transform humanity into undead servants. The **Custodi dell'Equilibrio**, an order dedicated to Tyr, want to recover it for their leader **Sir Alaric il Giusto** — who hides personal ambitions of absolute power.

The saga takes place along the Sword Coast and beyond, from **Orcastle** (a prison-city under a magical dome) to the frozen lands of **Svoalbard** north of Bryn Shander.

Introduction

"I owe you my life. My wrath shall fall upon you if you do not begin searching for Lo Scettro di Tyr. Immeasurable rewards will be bestowed upon you if you accomplish the task."

The characters find themselves caught in a chain of events that takes them from forced service to a tyrant (Malebranche) to a mission on behalf of Vecna, until they must choose sides in a conflict between deities. Their moral choices determine the fate of entire kingdoms.

The adventure begins with the PCs being kidnapped by **Lord Cedric Malebranche**, who forces them to recover the **Pergamena del Giudizio** in the prison-city of Orcastle. From there, a pact with **Vecna** sends them on a quest for Lo Scettro di Tyr. The journey takes them through mountains, ruined temples, and alternate planes of existence, to the final showdown.

General Plot

- **Module A — Escape from Orcastle:** the PCs, kidnapped and fitted with explosive collars, must recover the Pergamena del Giudizio in the prison-city of Orcastle and find a way to escape. Four factions control the island, each with their own secrets.
- **Module B — Lo Scettro di Tyr:** Vecna tasks the PCs with recovering the Scepter from the Temple of Lumina. Journey from Baldur's Gate through dangerous mountains, trials of purity in the temple, and a final confrontation with Alaric il Giusto.
- **Module C — Return Home:** the PCs must deliver the Scepter to the altar of Tyr in Svoalbard. Sea voyage along the Sword Coast, pursued by a spy of Vecna and the warlock Othran Vorash.
- **Module D — The End Does Not Belong to the Dead:** Malebranche, defeated, summons the wizard Zikle and curses the PCs. The dead rise wherever they go. They must find the Monile d'Oro di Ostegard to break the curse and defeat Malebranche once and for all.

DM Advice

- **Tone:** dark fantasy with moments of moral tension. The PCs start on the side of evil (working for Vecna) and must earn their redemption. Moral choices have real mechanical consequences.
- **Continuity:** the modules are sequential. Characters like Frankie, Ombrascura, Kreig, Miranda, and Ruby return in different modules. Keep track of relationships.
- **Vecna:** is always present as a threat. If the PCs ignore his requests, they suffer progressive curses (d6 table in Module B). He is not an enemy to fight directly — he is a puppeteer.
- **The Scepter:** is an extremely powerful but dangerous object. Tyr's curse strikes anyone who touches it without being pure. Only the designated herald can wield it. Keep track of who carries it and the consequences.
- **Difficulty:** the adventure scales from lv8 (Module A) to lv10 (Modules C-D). Encounters are calibrated for 4-6 PCs. Module A has many non-combat options; Module D is the most combat-heavy.

Main NPCs

Full character sheets in [characters/markdown/](#).

Allies and Companions

- **Frankie Partenope** — human barbarian lv5, former adventurer and folk hero. Forced to cooperate with the PCs in Module A (explosive collar). Hates Malebranche. Returns in Module D as an ally.
- **Malachias Ombrascuro** (alias Elemir Strunz) — dragonborn cleric, stole the Pergamena del Giudizio. Hides in Orcastle under a false identity. Returns in Module D.
- **Brother Thaddeus** — monk, former disciple of Tyr. Left the order after discovering Alaric's true intentions. Offers crucial information in Module B.
- **Ludmilla Dawnshield** — human explorer, descendant of the first explorers of Svoalbard. Guides the PCs to the island in Module C.
- **Helmut Van Heuten** — merchant devoted to Tyr, finances and supports the mission in Module C.

Antagonists

- **Lord Cedric Malebranche** — archmage necromancer, corrupt governor. Mastermind behind the kidnapping in Module A. Final villain in Module D.
- **Sir Alaric il Giusto** — high priest of the Custodi dell'Equilibrio. Hides ambitions of absolute power. Antagonist of Module B.
- **Othran Vorash** — half-elf warlock of Vecna, lv10. Pursues the PCs to steal the Scepter in Modules C-D.
- **Zalhara Lorenn** — human spy in the service of Vecna. Travels on the same ship as the PCs in Module C.

Orcastle Factions (Module A)

- **Axel Ruby** — leader of the Ruby gang (east), former vassal of Malebranche.
- **Miranda Emerald** — leader of the Emerald gang (west), illusionist mage.
- **Lord Kreig Highlander** — leader of the Castro (center), secret cousin of Malebranche. Becomes count in Module D.

Deities and Entities

- **Vecna** — God of Secrets. Manipulator, does not fight directly. Appears as an avatar at the Torre di Torth.
- **Tyr** — God of Justice. Appears at the Temple of Lumina and in Svoalbard. Poses trials of purity.

Secondary Characters

- **Mesusu Merconè** — dwarf, captain of the flying ship Airborne.
- **Kurzum** — dwarf, owner of the Giavellotto Fantasma, mission broker.

- **Zikle l'Illuminato** — goblin wizard, creator of the Pergamena del Giudizio. Killed by Malebranche, summoned as a wraith in Module D.
- **Tungsten** — dwarf, former adventuring companion of the PCs (friendly NPC already known from previous adventures). Left the adventuring life, moved to the Sword Coast, and opened the tavern *All'orco che rutta* in Waterdeep. Marries Grimilda in the Module D epilogue.
- **Orlomm Glittergear** — gnome, captain of the ship *La Nuova Speranza* (Module C).
- **Tungsten** — former herald, groom at the wedding in the epilogue (Module D).

Key Items

La Pergamena del Giudizio (Module A)

Contains the spell to bring down the magical dome of Orcastle. Protected by a curse: only a paladin or a character pure of heart can activate it (plus the secret word known to Ombrascuro). Also includes a message spell with the password "Zikle l'Illuminato".

Lo Scettro di Tyr (Modules B-C)

Divine crystal weapon. Properties: Sacred Resurrection (1 charge), Empowerment of Justice (+2 to hit, necrotic/psychic resistance, advantage vs fear within 30 feet), Shield of Purity (1/day, halves damage for 3 turns), Sentence of Tyr (1/day, paralysis + truth). Curse: anyone who touches it without Tyr's consent suffers nightmares, halved healing, maximum HP halved each day until death or repentance.

La Coppa di Blackwood (Module A)

Artifact in the Torre di Torth. Functions as Dispel Magic (powerful enough for the collars). Magic word: "Obloc Vecnal" (Praise Vecna in Infernal).

Il Monile d'Oro di Ostegard (Module D)

Talisman that channels sacred energy to disperse necromantic corruption. Kept in the Sunken Sanctuary of Ostegard, guarded by Sir Aldric (sword wraith).

Adventure Structure

#	name	level	type	file
A	Escape from Orcastle	lv8, 5-6 PCs	sandbox / exploration	01_FugaDaOrcastle/ FugaDaOrcastle.md
B	Lo Scettro di Tyr	lv9, 4-5 PCs	travel / dungeon	02_LoScettroDiTyr/ LoScettroDiTyr.md
C	Return Home	lv10, 4-5 PCs	travel / intrigue	03_RitornoACasa/ RitornoACasa.md
D	The End Does Not Belong to the Dead	lv10, 5-6 PCs	travel / combat	04_LaFineNonAppartieneAiMorti/ LaFineNonAppartieneAiMorti.md

Future Hooks

- The pact with Vecna at the Torre di Torth (Module A) can be a hook for subsequent adventures
- The three good deeds required by Tyr to become pure (Module B) can be hooks for one-shots
- Tyr's final voice in Svoalbard (Module C) promises a future call against Vecna
- Tungsten's wedding (Module D epilogue) is a natural starting point for new adventures

Appendix — Stat Blocks

GUARDIAN OF LUMINA

Medium humanoid (construct (stone golem)), neutral (corrupted by vecna)

temple guardian, potential ally

Armor Class 17

Hit Points 50 (of 178 maximum — heavily wounded)

Speed 10 ft.

Challenge 5

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	9 (-1)	20 (+5)	3 (-4)	11 (+0)	1 (-5)

Magic Resistance. advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects

Immunity to Non-Magical Weapons. immune to damage from non-magical or non-silvered weapons

Corruption Aura (only if corrupted). each creature within 3m / 10ft / 2qd must make a Constitution save DC 14 at the start of its turn or take 5 (1d10) necrotic damage

ACTIONS

Fist (melee). Attack: +8, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd Damage: 3d8+6 bludgeoning

Dark Burst (1/combat, only if corrupted). Range: 4.5m / 15ft / 3qd Saving Throw: Dexterity DC 15 Failure: 3d8+6 necrotic damage Success: half damage

AXEL RUBY

Medium humanoid (human), chaotic evil
leader of the Ruby gang (east Orcastle)



Armor Class 11 (leather armor)

Hit Points 32 (5d8+10)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 10

Languages any one (usually Common)

Challenge 1/2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)

BROTHER THADDEUS

Medium humanoid (human), lawful good
informant, former disciple of Tyr

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 1

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

FRANKIE PARTENOPE

*Medium humanoid (human), chaotic neutral
allied NPC of the party*



Armor Class 16 (Unarmored Defense: 10 + DEX +3 + CON +3)

Hit Points 47 (5d12 + 15)

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 4

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	8 (-1)	18 (+4)	8 (-1)

ACTIONS

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Battleaxe (melee). Attack: +8 Damage: 1d10+5
slashing

HELMUT VAN HEUTEN

Medium humanoid (human), lawful good
secondary

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 1

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

KREIGHIGHLANDER

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

leader of the Castro (center of Orcastle); Count Wildforge in Module D



Armor Class 18 (plate armor)

Hit Points 52 (8d8+16)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 10

Languages any one (usually Common)

Challenge 3

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	11 (+0)	15 (+2)

KURZUM

*Medium humanoid (dwarf), lawful evil
secondary*



Armor Class 17 (splint armor)

Hit Points 58 (9d8+18)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 12

Languages any one (usually Common)

Challenge 3

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

LORD MALEBRANCHE

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil
main antagonist



Armor Class 15 (Mage Armor)

Hit Points 99 (18d8 + 18)

Speed 30 ft.

Damage Resistances necrotic

Senses Passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Draconic, Infernal, Abyssal

Challenge 12

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	20 (+5)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)

Magic Resistance. advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects

Corrupt Will. when Malebranche deals necrotic damage, he regains temporary HP equal to half the damage dealt

Legendary Actions (3/round). Malebranche can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the following. Only one at a time, at the end of another creature's turn.

Cantrip (1 action). casts a cantrip

Rapid Summoning (2 actions). summons 1d4 skeletons (CR 1/4) in unoccupied spaces within 9m / 30ft

Life Drain (1 action). a creature within 9m / 30ft must succeed on a Constitution save DC 17 or take 2d8 necrotic damage. Malebranche regains HP equal to the damage dealt.

ACTIONS

Necrotic Ray (ranged). Attack: +9, range 36m / 120ft / 24qd Damage: 3d10 necrotic

LUDMILLADAWNSHIELD

*Medium humanoid (human), neutral good
ally*

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 1

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

MALACHIAS OMBRASCURA

Medium humanoid (dragonborn), to be determined in play
ambiguous allied NPC



Armor Class 13 (chain shirt)

Hit Points 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 13

Languages Common, Draconic

Challenge 2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)

Breath Weapon. once per short rest, 4.5m / 15ft / 3qd cone. Dexterity save DC 11, 2d6 damage (type depends on lineage — to be defined).

Divine Eminence. as a bonus action, can grant a creature within 9m / 30ft a 1d4 bonus to an attack roll or saving throw (3 uses/day).

MESUSUMERCON

*Medium humanoid (dwarf), lawful neutral
secondary*



Armor Class 16 (chain shirt, shield)

Hit Points 11 (2d8+2)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 12

Languages any one (usually Common)

Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

MIRANDA EMERALD

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil
leader of the Emerald gang (west Orcastle)



Armor Class 12

Hit Points 27 (6d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Elvish

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Sneak Attack (1/turn). +2d6 extra damage if she has advantage or an ally in melee with the target

Cunning Action. Dash, Disengage, or Hide as a bonus action

ORLOMMGLITTERGEAR

Small humanoid (gnome), neutral good
captain of the ship La Nuova Speranza

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 1

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

OTHRANVORASH

*Medium humanoid (half-elf), neutral evil
recurring antagonist*

Armor Class 15 (reinforced light chain shirt + DEX)

Hit Points 84

Speed 30 ft.

Senses darkvision 18m

Languages Common, Elvish

Challenge 9

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	18 (+4)

ACTIONS

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Dagger (melee/ranged). Attack: +6 Damage: 1d4+3
piercing

SIRALARIC

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil (disguised as lawful neutral)

antagonist

Armor Class 15 (Mage Armor)

Hit Points 90 (12d8 + 36)

Speed 30 ft.

Damage Resistances necrotic, psychic

Condition Immunities frightened

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

SIRALDRIC

*Medium humanoid (human (sword wraith)), lawful neutral
guardian of the Golden Brooch of Ostegard*

Armor Class 18 (spectral armor)

Hit Points 127 (15d8 + 60)

Speed 30 ft.

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing,
and slashing from nonmagical weapons

Condition Immunities exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses darkvision 18m / 60ft, Passive Perception 14

Languages Common

Challenge 8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Partial Incorporeality. Sir Aldric can move through creatures and objects as difficult terrain. He takes 5 (1d10) force damage if he ends his turn inside an object.

Command Aura (9m / 30ft). allied undead within the aura have advantage on attack rolls.

Guardian's Will. if reduced to 0 HP, he can make a Constitution save DC 10 (+1 for each time after the first). On a success, he returns to 1 HP.

ACTIONS

Spectral Greatsword (melee). Attack: +7, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd Damage: 2d6+4 slashing + 2d6 necrotic

Multiattack. Sir Aldric makes two attacks with the Spectral Greatsword.

ZALHARA LORENN

*Medium humanoid (human), neutral evil
spy in service of Vecna*

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 27 (6d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Senses Passive Perception 16

Languages any two

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

ZIKLE

*Medium humanoid (goblin), chaotic neutral
secondary*



Armor Class 10

Hit Points 1

Speed 30 ft.

Challenge 1

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)
